

HYCLE IN ACTION / DAY 2, 14:00

The factory is the **easy** part.

You built a factory. Now change the organization that decides what it builds.

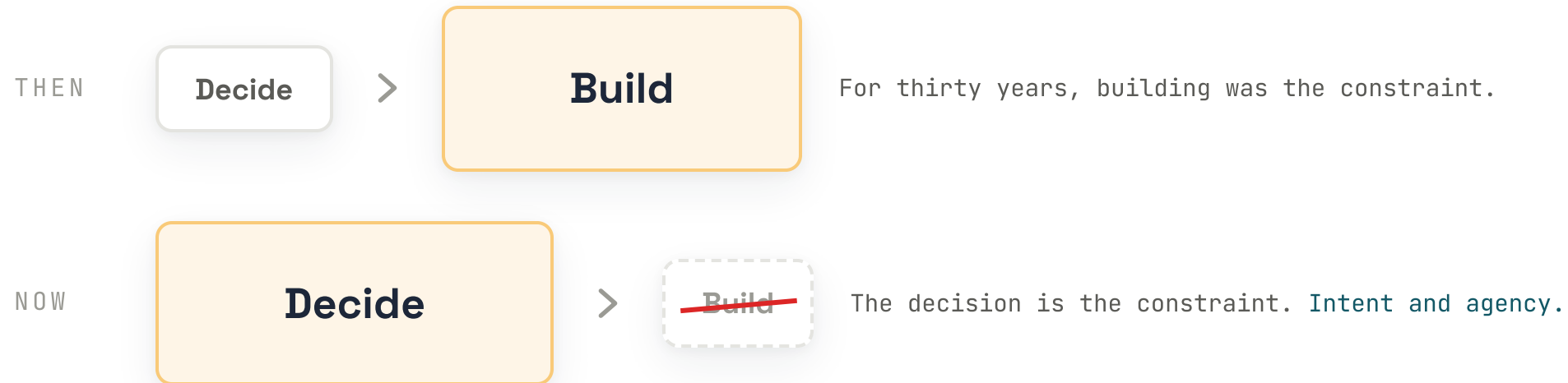
Andreas Stephan

A DAY AND A HALF AGO, YOU BUILT A SOFTWARE FACTORY

It works.

On Day 1, Tereza told you starting is simple and the team factory is the uncharted part. She was right, and what she set up I am here to answer. A factory is a magnifying glass: it amplifies whatever your organization already is. On its own it will not make your company better. It can even make it worse. For the next twenty minutes, let me convince you why, and what to change.

The bottleneck moved.



WHAT SITS UPSTREAM NOW

The constraint is the decision.

WHAT TO BUILD

Intent

What the customer actually needs. The one thing an agent can never hand you.

THE ABILITY TO ACT

Agency

Handlungsfähigkeit: competence, authority, and information together. Only those who know can decide — so knowledge sharing and failure culture are structural, not cultural.

When execution was slow, you never noticed these were the real bottleneck. Now building is instant, and the slow decision is exposed.

THE TRAP

There is nothing so useless as doing efficiently that which should not be done at all.

Peter Drucker

Two futures follow from here. Both bad.

Speed up execution, leave the decision where it is.

FUTURE ONE

Faster waste

Build the wrong thing in a day
instead of in two weeks

The build trap on a faster engine
more code, none of it closer to a customer

The empty backlog is a smoke alarm
you build faster than you can decide

FUTURE TWO

Rationalization

Same output, fewer people
cut cost, hold output

The market rewards it
in the short term

Not innovation
cheaper while you wait to be disrupted

RATIONALIZATION, MADE REAL

Block, February 2026.

40%

OF STAFF CUT

4,000+

PEOPLE

AI named as the reason. The stock went up. A real strategy that pays in the short term. Just do not call it innovation.

Sources: CNN, Fortune, 2026

TWO FUTURES, ONE NON-CHOICE

These are the same future.

Both are what happens when you leave the decision where it is. The third path, the one where the factory makes you better, is a choice, and the factory will not make it for you.

THE THIRD PATH

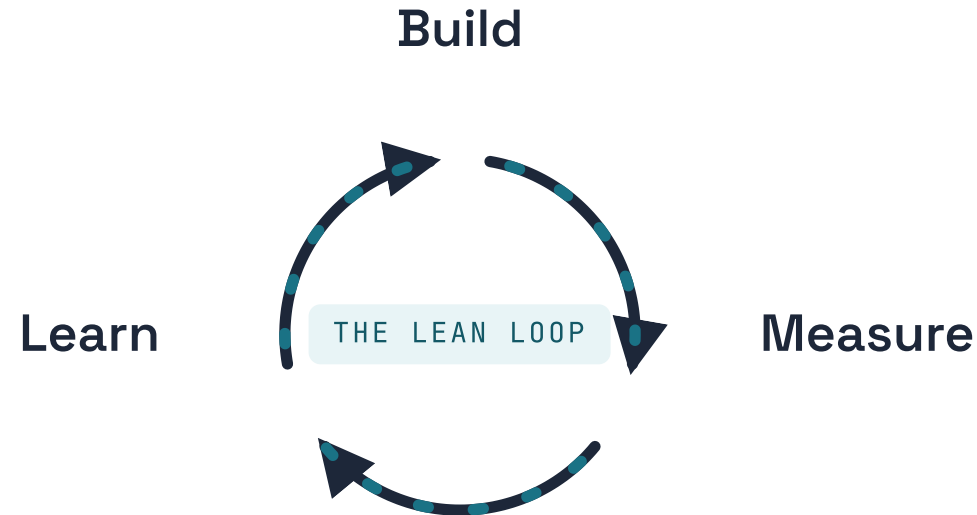
Delightful products.

MVPs were often mediocre compromises. Now software is malleable. You can build what genuinely meets a customer's need, and reach problems that were too expensive to touch before. But only if you listen, reflect, and learn.

**You can finally build what the customer actually needs.
That is what this unlocks.**

THE LOOP YOU CANNOT SKIP

Build, measure, learn.



Many teams only optimize build. The learning is where a product gets good.

Exhale. Reflect. Try again. Kill bad ideas early.

WHAT ACTUALLY CHANGES

Three shifts. None of them technical.

01 **Aim at decisions, not execution**

Don't only measure how fast you can build. Time your slowest decision. That number is your real cycle time.

02 **Agency needs to be pushed down, create the right environment**

Information (only those who know can decide), Strategy (the frame that prevents chaos at speed), Decision Architecture (what replaces Scrum's gates). All three must live in the team.

03 **Embrace blurring roles**

Discovery is the job an agent cannot do, and it is partly becoming yours.

You do not need permission to start. Stop outsourcing discovery to one PM. Agree what you do the moment a decision is blocked.

ALREADY HAPPENING, IN THE WILD

Scrum was a buffer for when code was expensive. I killed it.

Andreas Stryz, CTO at FINN, 2026

Micro teams. One PM, two product engineers. Each team owns one KPI, not a backlog.

WHY THIS IS HARD

What is yours, and what is not.

YOURS, ON MONDAY

Your team

Build discovery in. Agree how you act when a decision is blocked. Prove it on your team, with a business KPI that moved. Nobody upstairs has to approve that.

ORG-LEVEL CONVERSATIONS

Strategy & Authority

You can redesign your team's decision architecture. You cannot change the org's authority structure or strategy from inside your team. That takes conversations with people above you.

The frustration when a good idea dies in an approval queue is not noise. It is data. It points at the structure that has to change.

SO TAKE OWNERSHIP

Do you drive Notion like it's stolen?

Max Schoening, Head of Product at Notion

You may not own it officially. Move like you do. The decisions in your domain are yours to take.

WHERE THESE THOUGHTS COME FROM

hycle

An open inquiry into how organizations change when execution stops being the bottleneck. Three words hide in the name. **Hypercycle**: coupled cycles that feed each other, the pattern that carried life from chemistry to biology. In German it sounds like **heikel**, delicate; reorganizing usually is. And **hype cycle** is in there too, for what stays once the hype is gone. hycle.org.

THREE THOUGHTS TO TAKE INTO THE AFTERNOON

For your own organization

- 01 **A decision you cannot make today**
that you would need to make to use this factory fully.
- 02 **Who holds the authority and the information you are missing**
and when did you last actually talk to them?
- 03 **One structure to change first**
a role, a cadence, an approval. Which one?

You built the factory.

Now go change the organization that decides what it builds, and share your failures and successes with us at hycle.org.